Incident Report: SSH brute force

Status: open | Generated (UTC): 2026-10-31T17:52:45.629Z

1. Evidence & integrity (hashes re-verified at report time)

File	Type	SHA-256	Bytes	Verification	Skew / Offset	Parsing coverage
auth.log	auth	14acd2d17f27e96751e2ad2c2356a3398587715eae8b54ea04bc95fd0d8e4bf3	1222	verified	0s / UTC+0m	84.62% (11/13)

Amatching hash shows the stored file is unchanged since collection; it does not by itself prove the file was authentic when collected.

2. Rule-based findings

Severity	Finding	Detail
high	SSH brute force followed by successful login from 203.0.113.45	8 failed logins starting 2026-10-20T10:00:00.000Z; successful login as "admin" at 2026-10-20T10:00:30.000Z

3. Unified timeline (UTC)

UTC time	Original	Source	Event	IP	User	Details
2026-10-20T09:55:00.000Z	Oct 20 09:55:00	auth	successful_login	198.51.100.7	deploy	[srv1 sshd] Accepted publickey login for deploy from 198.51.100.7
2026-10-20T10:00:00.000Z	Oct 20 10:00:00	auth	failed_login	203.0.113.45	root	[srv1 sshd] Failed password login for root from 203.0.113.45
2026-10-20T10:00:03.000Z	Oct 20 10:00:03	auth	failed_login	203.0.113.45	admin	[srv1 sshd] Failed password login for admin from 203.0.113.45
2026-10-20T10:00:06.000Z	Oct 20 10:00:06	auth	failed_login	203.0.113.45	oracle	[srv1 sshd] Failed password login for oracle from 203.0.113.45
2026-10-20T10:00:09.000Z	Oct 20 10:00:09	auth	failed_login	203.0.113.45	test	[srv1 sshd] Failed password login for test from 203.0.113.45
2026-10-20T10:00:12.000Z	Oct 20 10:00:12	auth	failed_login	203.0.113.45	root	[srv1 sshd] Failed password login for root from 203.0.113.45
2026-10-20T10:00:15.000Z	Oct 20 10:00:15	auth	failed_login	203.0.113.45	admin	[srv1 sshd] Failed password login for admin from 203.0.113.45
2026-10-20T10:00:18.000Z	Oct 20 10:00:18	auth	failed_login	203.0.113.45	oracle	[srv1 sshd] Failed password login for oracle from 203.0.113.45
2026-10-20T10:00:21.000Z	Oct 20 10:00:21	auth	failed_login	203.0.113.45	test	[srv1 sshd] Failed password login for test from 203.0.113.45

2026-10-20T10:00:30.000Z	Oct 20 10:00:30	auth	successful_login	203.0.113.45	admin	[srv1 sshd] Accepted password login for admin from 203.0.113.45
2026-10-20T10:02:00.000Z	Oct 20 10:02:00	auth	other	203.0.113.45		[srv1 sshd] Disconnected from user admin 203.0.113.45 port 40010

4. Parsing gaps

Line	Reason	Raw line
10	Line does not match syslog (auth.log) format	`this line is corrupted and cannot be parsed`
12	Invalid time value	`Oct 32 25:61:00 srv1 sshd[1201]: impossible timestamp`